

Statistics to measure

Some common statistics that you can collect for your website are:

- ◆ **Sessions:** The total number of visits to your site. This number shouldn't just be high, it should be higher than it was previously.
- ◆ **Users:** This is the number of unique visitors to your site. The number of sessions can give you an idea of the quality of your site and its stickiness.
- ◆ **Time-per-visit:** The average amount of time a user spends on your website. This is also an indicator of quality, but whether it should be high or low depends on the purpose of the website. (ex - it should be high for a content focused website, but low for a utility website)
- ◆ **Pages-per-visit:** This is the average number of pages a user navigates through per visit to your site. Again, whether the number should be high or low is contextual.
- ◆ **Pageviews:** Similar to the previous metric, this is the total number of times any page was loaded on your site for any user.
- ◆ **Bounce rate:** This metric measures the number of visitors that leave your site without clicking on or doing anything.

Of course, each of these statistics must be interpreted according to the context and your needs (business goals).

Tools to collect data

Here are some commonly used tools to collect objective statistics and data:

- ◆ **Analytics:** Many companies (such as Google) provide software that track everything a user does on your site. You can even design your own criteria!
- ◆ **A/B Tests:** This refers to launching two versions of the same product simultaneously and observing how they fare in comparison. This may or may not be a controlled test.
- ◆ **Heatmaps:** Some vendors provide software that records the whole interface while the user is interacting with it, thus you can later analyse everything from scroll speed to where the mouse hovered.
- ◆ **Search logs:** To know what's not easily accessible on your site, look at this simple, but powerful tool that lets you know what users have searched for the most. 